

Screen Size and Graphics Content

Several factors come into play when determining what size screen to use. This rule of thumb will show you the minimum, in most circumstances larger is beneficial.

Things to Do:

- Measure distance from screen to back row and divide by 6. This is the minimum screen width.
 - For instance – if the last row is 48ft. from the screen, then an 8ft. wide screen is the minimum size. If you can get a 10ft. wide screen it's better.
- Front row should be at least 1 and ½ the width of the screen from the screen surface. In our 8ft. screen scenario, front row should be 12ft. from the screen for best viewing, 10ft. if you need to do that usually works.
- The average person sitting down is 4 ½ ft. from head to the ground, if you place the bottom the screen at 5ft. more people can see the full screen.
- Try to have at least 1ft. above the top of the screen to the ceiling.
- There are a lot of low ceilings in venues out there, and you have to adapt. Multiple screens, turning the room and going to the shorter depth are good starts

How Much Content on a Graphic:

The rule of thumb is that less is more. However; stand back about 7 to 8 ft. from a 17 inch computer monitor. If you can't read the information, the back rows of your audience won't be able to either.

Determine Your **Actual** Seating Capacity

The room dimensions in the brochure are 100ft. x 80ft. 8,000 sq. ft. The venue brochure may say that can hold 1000 or more people theater style. However; what is the real story once you use common sense? There are footages to be deducted even in a small production.

- How wide is your center aisle?
- Is there only 1 center aisle or two?
- How wide are side aisles?
- How much room do you want between the back wall and the back row of seating?
- From the back wall:
- How much backstage or rear projection room do you need?
- Add the depth of your stage
- What is the distance from the front of stage to the first row of the audience seats?

All these elements take away from that big 100ft. x 80ft. ballroom. See the drawing on the side to see the real square footage available for seating.

On our website you can find a room calculator that will help you determine how many people can really fit into the ballroom within your specifications. www.thecanonhouse.com